

Vinh Ly

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Summary

Full stack engineer with **14 years of experience** building and shipping production systems at scale. Comfortable across the entire stack, with a recent focus on **Python** backends, **Node.js** services, and **React** frontends handling tens of millions of users. Looking for a role where I can apply that breadth to education-focused web products.

Core Skills

Languages: Python, Node.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, Go, Java

Frontend: React, Vue.js, HTML/CSS, SASS, webpack

Backend: Django, Flask, FastAPI, Express, GraphQL, REST APIs

Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Bigtable

Infra: Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, AWS, CI/CD pipelines, Git

Education

BS Computer Science | University of Louisiana at Lafayette | 2003 - 2007

Work Experience

Staff Software Engineer | YouTube | Remote | 02/2025-Present

- Working on video infrastructure serving over 2 billion users. Owning reliability for backend services written in **Python** that handle upload workflows and content processing
- Led a migration of the thumbnail generation pipeline from legacy Java to **Python**. Cut processing latency roughly in half and reduced infrastructure costs.

Staff Software Engineer | Whatnot | Remote | 05/2024-02/2025

- Joined as a founding engineer on the commerce platform team at a live shopping startup. Helped design the real-time bidding service in **Node.js** handling thousands of concurrent auctions.
- Built out the seller dashboard in **React** from scratch, including order management, payout tracking, and analytics views. Worked directly with the product team to ship the first version in about two months.
- Set up the initial CI/CD pipelines in GitHub Actions and Docker, giving the team a repeatable deploy process for the first time.

Staff Software Engineer / Manager | Google | Remote | 03/2015 - 04/2024

- Managed a team of 5 engineers building internal tooling for Google's advertising systems. Set priorities, ran performance reviews, and unblocked technical decisions across a **Python** and **Java** codebase.
- Redesigned the campaign forecasting dashboard used by internal sales teams. Moved from a slow monolithic app to a set of **React** micro-frontends backed by a **Python** API layer. Page load dropped from about 8 seconds to under 1 second.
- Worked with data engineering to replace a manual reporting process that took 2 days of analyst time each week. The new **Python** pipeline in Airflow ran nightly and emailed pre-built reports. Analysts got their mornings back.
- Served as technical lead for a project migrating a legacy Perl service to **Python**. Coordinated across three teams, wrote the migration playbook, and ran the cutover in a single weekend with no downtime.
- Mentored four junior engineers on the team. Ran weekly 1:1s and code reviews until each was driving their own features end-to-end.

Software Engineer | Google | Remote | 02/2011 - 02/2015

- Worked on Google's internal code review tool, Gerrit. Built new features in **Java** and **JavaScript**, fixed tricky edge cases in the diff rendering engine, and triaged bugs from internal users.
- Contributed to the search infrastructure team supporting Google.com. Wrote **Java** code in the query processing pipeline, mostly around caching and result ranking refinements.
- Took ownership of a flaky integration test suite that was causing slowdowns in the CI pipeline. Reduced false positives from around 30% down to under 5% over a couple of months of targeted debugging.

Software Design Engineer II | Microsoft | Hybrid | 10/2007 - 12/2011

- Worked on the SharePoint enterprise search team. Built and maintained features in **C#** and **JavaScript** for the search center, including custom refiners and result ranking rules.
- Rewrote a slow content indexing job that was blocking deployments. The **C#** rewrite cut runtime from roughly 4 hours to about 20 minutes, which let the team ship faster.
- Collaborated with QA engineers and program managers on a quarterly release cycle, owning the search relevance feature area end-to-end from spec to ship.

Software Design Engineer Intern | Microsoft | Hybrid | 06/2006 - 08/2006

- Built a prototype reporting tool for the IT help desk in **C#**. Shipped to a small internal team and used for a couple of years before being replaced by a larger platform effort.